

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Central question and the three faces of one population

CENTRAL QUESTION -> is a diaspora an asset, an obligation or a liability?

ANSWER -> all three at once, which is why the tracks must be separated

TRACK 1 -> WELFARE AND CONSULAR PROTECTION: a standing state obligation

TRACK 2 -> SOFT POWER AND CULTURAL PROJECTION: an influence asset

TRACK 3 -> HOST-COUNTRY POLITICS: access, advocacy and friction together

FRAME -> two-way bridge, expressly not a foreign-policy lever to be directed

BOUNDARY -> OCI doctrine to Polity; remittance mechanics to Economy;

relief logistics to Disaster Management; Gulf exposure to topic 06

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Categories and the population table read correctly

MEA TABLE, AS ON JANUARY 2026 -> 35,421,987 overseas Indians

NRIs (Indian citizens resident abroad) -> 19,571,375

PIOs (foreign nationals of Indian origin) -> 15,850,612

TOP HOSTS -> United States 6,079,221 | United Arab Emirates 4,344,008

Malaysia 2,902,370 | Saudi Arabia 2,750,551

STATUS -> population-stock estimates only

NOT -> a count of Indian citizens abroad; not a count of OCI cards issued

OCI -> rights and benefits for foreign nationals of Indian origin, not dual citizenship

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Welfare and consular stack, instrument by instrument

PRAVASI BHARATIYA DIVAS -> 18th edition, 8-10 January 2025, Bhubaneswar, Odisha

theme: Diaspora's Contribution to a Viksit Bharat; no 19th edition recorded

MADAD -> launched 21 February 2015; MADAD 2.0 launched December 2025,

linked with e-Migrate and the Pravasi Bharatiya Sahayata Kendras

ICWF -> emergency medical care, air passage and legal aid

e-MIGRATE -> registers and clears ECR workers; routes grievances to MADAD

PBBY -> compulsory ECR insurance; ten lakh rupees accidental-death cover;

8,536,398 beneficiaries and 2,222 claims settled through October 2025

PROTECTOR GENERAL OF EMIGRANTS -> emigration clearance and worker protection

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: The treaty frame with its dates and its exact limit

4 MARCH - 22 APRIL 1963 -> UN Conference on Consular Relations at Vienna;
attended by delegates of ninety-five States

24 APRIL 1963 -> Convention adopted and opened for signature, together with the
Optional Protocol concerning Acquisition of Nationality and the Optional
Protocol concerning the Compulsory Settlement of Disputes

19 MARCH 1967 -> the Convention and both Optional Protocols come into force

STRUCTURE -> 79 articles

ARTICLE 36 -> consular notification and effective access on arrest or detention

LIMIT -> a reciprocal procedural safeguard, not a power to override host law

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Routine consular work against crisis evacuation

ROUTINE -> grievances, documentation, welfare, prisoner and undertrial access

SCALE: 10,152 Indian prisoners and undertrials abroad, Lok Sabha answer

dated 28 March 2025; a workload measure, never a wrongdoing measure

CRISIS -> host-government negotiation, air access, consular readiness

WORKED EXAMPLE: Operation Sindhu, 4,415 nationals evacuated by 27 June 2025

3,597 from Iran and 818 from Israel

OWNED HERE -> the diplomacy that makes an evacuation possible

OWNED ELSEWHERE -> the relief and logistics cycle, by Disaster Management

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Remittance weight and the boundary it must not cross

WORLD'S LARGEST RECIPIENT -> Economic Survey 2025-26

FY11 -> USD 55.6 billion

FY25 -> USD 135.4 billion provisional, about 3.5 per cent of GDP

H1 FY26 -> USD 73 billion against USD 64.7 billion a year earlier

OWNED BY ECONOMY -> the macroeconomic mechanics of these flows

OWNED HERE -> the diplomatic and cultural bridge the flows accompany

RULE -> never answer a political-influence question with a remittance number

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Where the money now comes from and why it matters

RBI SIXTH SURVEY ON REMITTANCES, FY24 -> advanced economies exceed the GCC

United States 27.7% | United Arab Emirates 19.2%

United Kingdom 10.8% | Singapore 6.6%

MEANING -> the centre of gravity shifts from low-skilled Gulf labour towards skilled professional migration to advanced economies

CONSEQUENCE -> different host relationships now carry the consular weight

CONSEQUENCE -> different instruments are needed, not simply more of the same

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: The mismatch between instrument and population

PROBLEM -> the protection stack is tied to the ECR clearance category

RESPONSE: it works well for low-wage Gulf migration and reaches that group

PROBLEM -> the fastest-growing segment is skilled migration to advanced economies

RESPONSE: its constraints are visa regimes, social-security portability and professional qualification recognition, none of which clearance touches

DIAGNOSIS -> a design gap, expressly not a funding shortfall

PRESCRIPTION -> match the instrument to the segment before adding capacity

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: The soft-power inventory and the training instrument

CULTURAL -> Bollywood cinema | books and music | cultural schemes

KNOWLEDGE -> educational opportunities | health care

WELLNESS -> Ayurveda | yoga

PEOPLE -> sporting exchanges | tourism

IMAGE -> the transformed image of the country created by its thriving diaspora

INSTITUTIONS -> Indian Council for Cultural Relations; public diplomacy division

ITEC (Economic Survey 2025-26) -> more than two lakh persons trained from over one hundred and sixty countries, civilian and defence sectors; an important tool of cultural diplomacy, especially the South Asian region

LIMIT -> the cultural-diplomacy effect is not uniform across all partner countries

DO NOT CONFUSE -> ITEC is training cooperation with partner governments, while Pravasi Bharatiya Divas is a diaspora-recognition convening event

RULE -> evidence soft power through this inventory, never through vague appeal

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Two internal constraints that outweigh external competition

CONSTRAINT 1 -> institutional fragmentation

promotion left solely to ICCR and the public diplomacy division

-> proposed remedy: make it integral to the substantive territorial divisions

-> STATUS: a documented proposal, expressly not an implemented reform

CONSTRAINT 2 -> authenticity

a narrow or restricted version of Indianness does not project soft power

-> it must reflect multi-religious identities and linguistic diversity

-> ASYMMETRY: one domestic incident can undo cumulative external investment

POLICY ARGUMENT -> Now-Required-Indians, conditional on a channelling policy

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Indian citizen, Overseas Citizen of India cardholder, Person of Indian...

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Political access and the same asset as a liability

ACCESS -> Kamala Harris, US Vice-President 2021-2025

Rishi Sunak, UK Prime Minister 2022-2024

119th Congress: six Indian-American members of the House

MECHANISM -> networks and coalitions, not votes alone; scholarship on the

2005-2008 India-US civil-nuclear initiative records organisational advocacy

LIMIT -> office-holders act under host-country mandates, not as agents of India

LIMIT -> party, constituency and committee incentives outweigh ancestry

LIABILITY -> diaspora-linked separatism or a security dispute converts a
community connection into a sovereignty and law-enforcement problem

DISCIPLINE -> separate allegation, charge, plea and final judicial finding

EVIDENCE LIMIT: STATUS / LEVELS / IMPLEMENTATION: Use the Vienna Convention on Consular...

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Answer spine for a diaspora or soft-power demand

OPEN -> name the category, its stock figure and its exact status in one line

SPLIT -> welfare and consular protection against cultural soft-power projection

EVIDENCE -> treaty frame, welfare stack, one dated evacuation, remittance shift

POLITICS -> access and advocacy with the host-country mandate limit attached

DIAGNOSE -> fragmentation, authenticity and the instrument-population mismatch

OWNERSHIP -> the 2020 Comment and 2023 Describe demands are the routed questions

CLOSE -> bridge rather than lever; predict no host-country political outcome